

AI Fundamentals

Module 1

Collaborate with AI

Module 2

Practice using AI

01: Tell us about your experience with AI in under 2 minutes
Ungraded Quiz • 15 min

02: Get the most out of Labs
Reading • 4 min

03: Complete labs with Google AI Pro at no cost
Reading • 4 min

04: Walkthrough Google AI Pro trial
Ungraded Quiz • 15 min

05: Brainstorm ideas with Gemini
Lab • 12 min

06: Could how fast AI been blowing your mind recently?
Video • 42 sec

Module 3

Learn how AI works

01: Learn foundational AI concepts
Video • 2 min

02: Fundamentals of machine learning
Reading • 4 min

03: Historical adaptations
Reading • 8 min

04: Leverage AI features and capabilities for work
Video • 4 min

Module 4

Design great prompts

01: Learn how to prompt AI to get helpful results
Video • 4 min

02: Prompting tips and tricks
Reading • 8 min

03: Apply the prompting framework in Gemini
Lab • 12 min

04: Well, what is your go-to prompting trick?
Video • 16 sec

Module 5

Level up your prompts

01: Prompt chaining strategies
Reading • 8 min

02: Practice prompt chaining in Gemini
Lab • 12 min

03: Walk what to look for when Gemini is stuck in a new chat?
Video • 1 min

04: Generate images with AI
Reading • 4 min

05: Create custom images with Gemini
Lab • 12 min

Module 6

Use AI responsibly

Prompt chaining strategies

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- You've already learned the prompting framework (persona, task, context, and format) for writing a good prompt. Now, we'll build on that foundation with two advanced techniques that can help you tackle more complex work:
- Powerful prompt phrases:** This is about using specific, precise language inside a single prompt to improve the quality and depth of AI's response.
 - Prompt chaining:** This is about using a series of smaller, connected prompts to structure an entire conversation and break down a massive project.

Guide AI with powerful prompt phrases

Think of this as leveling up the communication with every prompt you write.

While there are no true magic words to use with AI, certain phrases can be more effective in getting you the outputs you need. Powerful prompt phrases don't just tell AI what to do. They guide how AI should get there by adding precision, setting boundaries, and forcing AI to use more complex reasoning paths.

Here are some examples of powerful prompt phrases:

Give AI a process to follow

- Think step-by-step.
- First, [action 1]. Second, [action 2]. Finally, [action 3].

Define the audience and tone

- Write this for an audience of [audience type, e.g., executives].
- The tone should be [tone, e.g., professional].

Set hard constraints

- Write a one paragraph summary.
- Focus exclusively on [topic A, e.g. revenue] and do not mention [topic B, e.g., costs].

Request a critique

- Critique this text from the perspective of a [role, e.g., potential customer].
- Play devil's advocate. What is the strongest counterargument to this?

Generate alternatives

- Give me 3 different versions of this.
- What's an alternative approach to solving this problem?

Deepen or expand on the initial output

- Elaborate on point 2.
- Provide more detail and specific examples for the section about [section].

But what happens when a task is so complex that even a well-phrased prompt isn't enough?

This is where prompt chaining, our second advanced technique, comes in. With prompt chaining, you'll move from performing a single step (the micro-level skill) to managing an entire workflow (the macro-level skill).

Manage more complex tasks with prompt chaining

Some tasks are too big for a single prompt. Prompt chaining helps you tackle large tasks by breaking them into a series of smaller, connected steps that are all in the same chat. It works like a factory assembly line: The output from one prompt is used as the input for the next, linking all your steps together like a chain.

A practical example:

Say you're trying to plan a vacation to Paris. You want to create an itinerary of the things you love most while maximizing logistics so you can be as efficient as possible with your time.

You could use prompt chaining in the following way:

Prompt 1: "I'm going to Paris for 3 days. I like art, historical sites, and parks. Suggest a few well-known places I should visit on my trip."

Prompt 2 (second prompt in chain): Using those locations, create a logical day-by-day itinerary that minimizes travel time.

Prompt 3 (third prompt in chain): For each day of the itinerary, suggest a few restaurants located near the suggested locations.

By breaking the task into logical, digestible steps and using the output of one prompt as the specific input for the next, you transform AI from a simple answer generator into a structured collaborator.

Unlock the power of prompt chaining

In the upcoming lab, we'll practice prompt chaining.

To do this, you'll follow a guided example that focuses on expanding services for a painting business. However, to get the most out of this lab, try imagining in your own details so the output is relevant to your actual work.

What you'll gain:

- Strategic collaboration:** Learn to use AI as a thought partner that can critique and refine your strategy rather than just execute simple commands.
- Complex problem solving:** Master the skill of breaking down overwhelming projects into clear and connected phases that build toward a final goal.
- Stronger outputs:** Discover how layering information over multiple attempts leads to deeper and more tailored results compared to a single, one-off request.

Apply what you learn:

Experiment with examples relevant to your role.

- If you work in **marketing**, try generating a campaign concept and then adding for a timeline to launch it.
- If you work in **sales**, try asking for a list of potential clients and then drafting a tailored outreach email for your top choice.
- If you work in **operations**, try identifying a workflow bottleneck and then requesting a step-by-step solution to fix it.

Go from viewing AI as a task completer to collaborating with it as a brainstorming partner, using conversation to turn abstract thoughts into concrete plans.

Ready to organize your workflow? Let's get started.

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